

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, SILCHAR REGION

1ST PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (Code No. 184)

CLASS-X- (2024-25) [SET 1]

SUBJECT- ENGLISH

Time allowed: 3 Hrs.

Maximum Marks: 80

General Instructions:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.

2. The question paper contains THREE sections –

Section – A: Reading Skills 20 Marks

Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills 20 Marks

Section – C: Literature 40 Marks

3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

SECTION A

READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1. Read the following text.

10

(1) Technology is making advancements at a rapid rate but at the cost of a valued tradition- the crafts industry. The traditional crafts industry is losing a lot of its trained and skilled craftsmen. With that, the art of embellishing brass and copper utensils with fine engravings is also disappearing. The government has identified around 35 crafts as languishing craft.

(2) The speciality of handcrafted items is their design, an association with long traditions belonging to a specific region. The word ‘handcrafted’ does not imply the involvement of dexterous human fingers or an agile mind with a moving spirit anymore. Lessening drudgery, increasing production, and promoting efficiency have taken precedence. Labour-saving devices are taking the place of handcrafted tools, and this has led to a decline in traditional craftsmanship and a loss of cultural heritage associated with these artisanal practices.

(3) Mechanisation has made its way into everything - cutting, polishing, edging, designing etc. Ideally, the use of machinery should be negligible and the handicrafts should be made purely by hand with a distinguishable artistic appeal. However, with the exception of small-scale industries, the export units are mostly operated by machines. The heavily computerised designs contribute to a faster production at lower costs

(4) Although mechanization of crafts poses a challenge to safeguarding traditional crafts, the artisans are lured with incentives in order to impart handicrafts training. Some makers do see machines as a time-saving blessing since they are now able to accomplish difficult and demanding tasks with relative ease. These machines might give a better finesse to these products but they don't stand out as handcrafted. Quantity has overtaken quality in this industry.

(5) A need to highlight the importance of the handmade aspect is required by both the government and private sectors, in order to amplify awareness and also support the culture of making handicrafts. A few artisans are still trying their best to rejuvenate and revive their culture and heritage but it's an uphill task competing with the machine-made goods. A multitude of artisans have changed their professions and are encouraging their progeny to follow suit. There are others who have stayed their ground but are clearly inclined towards buying machines.

(6) Nearly two decades ago, there were around 65 lakh artisans in the country. Three years ago, when the government started the process of granting a unique number to the artisans based on the Aadhaar card, 25 lakhs were identified. Loss of traditional crafts is clearly a worrying issue, but it stands to reason that forcing any artisan to follow old ways when concerns of livelihood overrule other considerations, is unfair.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage.

i. Why does the writer call handicrafts a 'Valued tradition?' (1)

ii. Replace the underlined phrase in the given sentence by choosing the correct option. (1)

If it continues, the workcation (work+ vacation) trend will be a powerful boost to domestic tourism operators failing to make progress in the economic slump caused due to the pandemic.

- A. Agile
- B. Precedence
- C. Languishing
- D. Lessening

iii. Complete the following sentence.

Artisans are choosing to work via machines rather than handcrafted tools because-----
--- (1)

iv. Why do the artisans need to be 'lured with incentives' to impart handicrafts training? (2)

v. List two likely impacts of the support of government and private sectors towards the culture of making handicrafts. (2)

vi. Complete the following sentence. (1)

The writer can justify an artist's act of abandoning her/his traditional craft for a more lucrative option via -----

vii. The passage includes some words that are opposites of each other. From the sets A - D below, identify a set of antonyms. (1)

- A. Appreciate-Applaud
- B. Automated Mechanical
- C. Homemade Machined
- D. Common Simple

viii. State whether the following line displays the writer's idea as simple/complex/outright/justified. (1)

Quantity has overtaken quality in this industry.

2. Read the following text. 10

1. Access to primary education is a basic right of every child. An effective primary education can build a solid foundation and open avenues for future success. With its profound implications on both the individual and society, primary education plays a crucial role in reducing extreme poverty and promoting social changes. The Sustainable Development Agenda acknowledges the importance of primary education in Goal 4 which stipulates that by 2030, the world should ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all, including a target on universal access to primary education. Though there are varying standards, primary education is typically designed for children 6 to 11 years of age.

2. Significant progress has been made toward achieving universal primary education. Globally, the adjusted net attendance rate reached 87 percent in 2019 and about four out of five children attending primary education completed it. Additionally, over the past two decades, the number of out-of-school children was reduced by over 40 percent. However, there is still a long way to go: 58 million children of primary school age remain out of school, with the majority of them coming from marginalised groups. In addition, recent Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys (MICS) results show that many children do not have foundational reading and numeracy skills, highlighting the massive challenge to achieving inclusive and equitable quality education for all.

3. Globally, a lower proportion of children from the poorest families attend primary education compared with their wealthier peers. While almost all children from the top wealth quintile attend primary education, only 75 percent of children from the bottom wealth quintile do.

4. Across different regions, household wealth impacts primary school completion rates differently. West and Central Africa has the largest gap of 58 percentage points in primary school completion rates between the richest and poorest quintiles. In contrast, in East Asia and the Pacific and Latin America and the Caribbean, children from the top and bottom wealth quintiles complete primary school at more similar rates, with a gap of just 13 percentage points.

5. In the past 20 years, the number of out-of-school children of primary education age

fell by more than 40 per cent, from 99 million in 2000 to 58 million in 2019. However, 54 per cent of these out-of-school children were girls. Despite this tremendous progress, the world must accelerate the pace at which the number of out-of-school children is reduced, as the total has remained stagnant since 2007.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

i. Complete the following sentence appropriately.

_____ have the highest rates of primary education completion in the rich quintile. 1

ii. Fill the blanks with the appropriate option from those given in brackets, based on your understanding of the passage:

There was a decline of _____ (from 99 million in 2000 to 58 million in 2019 / from 99 million in 2000 to 68 million in 2019) in the number of out-of-school children of primary education age is seen in the past two decades. 1

iii. How is primary education critical to both an individual and a society? 2

iv. State one target related to primary education. 1

v. How much decline in the number of out-of-school children of primary education age is seen in the past two decades? 1

vi. Which word can substitute the word 'Foundational' in the following, sentence from paragraph 2.

In addition, recent Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys (MICS) results show that many children do not have foundational reading and numeracy skills, highlighting the massive challenge to achieving inclusive and equitable quality education for all.

(a) Essential

(b) Fundamental

(c) Required

(d) Primary 1

vii. How does the Sustainable Development Goals give importance to primary education? 2

viii. In 2019, about four out of five children attending primary education completed it suggests that 1

(a) almost 100% children completed primary education

(b) about 80% children completed the primary education

(c) more than 80% children completed primary education

(d) less than 80% children completed primary education

SECTION B
WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR (20 MARKS)

Grammar

Q3 Attempt ANY TEN of twelve of the following tasks, as directed: 1x10

i) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete an online update.

A new understanding of the fundamental connection between mind and body explains phenomena such as phantom limbs, and _____ surprising implications.

- (a) have (b) are
(c) is (d) has

1

ii) Read the conversation between Sudhir and Riya. Complete the sentence by reporting Riya's reply correctly.

Sudhir : Riya, what is the reporting time for photo shoot tomorrow?

Riya : I have no clue as I was not there during the briefing.

Sudhir asked Riya what was the reporting time for photoshoot the following day. In response to his question, Riya answered that _____. 1

iii) Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line, from a magazine.

When our cherished ideas are contradicted by the facts, we _____ avoid the human tendency to double down on those ideas.

- (a) must (b) need
(c) can (d) could

1

iv) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line, from a news report.

As per the report, India will allowed food processors to import duty-free wheat against a commitment to export flour.

Option no. error correction

- (a) the a
(b) will would
(c) allowed allow
(d) against for

1

v) Complete the given narrative, by filling in the blank with the correct option:

The two parks in our locality have virtually _____ over by undesirable elements.

(a) been taking (b) take

(c) taken (d) been taken

1

Vi) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter.

Subject: Request for kind perusal

Dear Sir

This is to respectfully submit that the students of Agatha House _____ (seek)

approval for organising an Inter-house Rangoli Making Competition to be undertaken by the house.

1

vii) Report the dialogue between a father and his son, by completing the sentence.

Father : Why are you late from school, Amit?

Amit : While coming from school to bus stop, I slipped by stepping on a banana peel.

Father asked Amit _____ late from school. In response to the question, Amit replied

that while coming from school to bus stop, he had slipped by stepping on a banana peel.

1

viii) Identify the error in the given sentence, from a school magazine report and supply the correction.

Exploring solutions to brought awareness about celebrating festivals without harming ecology was the second objective of the competition.

Use the given format for your response.

Error

Correction

1

ix) Ahmed shared some information with Anmol about his visit to a book fair. Report Anmol's question.

Did you buy any book from the fair?

1

x) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the slogan by the Ministry for Child Welfare.

_____ we ask our children to reject junk food?

(a) Should

(b) Shouldn't

(c) Can

(d) Can't

1

xi) Identify the error on a shop's hoarding and supply the correction for the following sales offer.

SUPER SAVER DEALS !!!

With Mom and Me Super Saver Days Offers, got discounts on daily essentials, personal care, baby care, fashion, kitchen & dining, nutrition, and more.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction	1
-------	------------	---

xii) Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue between Sanskriti and her friend Pranika.

Sanskriti : I couldn't find you on the school bus this morning. Did you miss the school bus?

Pranika : No, my dad was enroute to the school. So, he offered me to drop me to the school.

Sanskriti told Pranika that she couldn't see her on the school bus that morning and further asked _____. In response to her question, Pranika replied that her father was enroute to the school and offered her to drop her to the school.

(a) that if she had missed the school bus

(b) if she had missed the school bus

(c) that if she missed the school bus

(d) that if you had missed the school bus 1

WRITING

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4.A. As Vaishali Nathani of 214, Indrayani Apartments, Vaishali Street, Daipur, you believe that forming Ecology clubs and appointing Eco-minders in your city can aid in the preservation and conservation of nature.

Write a letter to the MLA of your city area, in about 120 words, suggesting the need to form such clubs. Share their importance and implications. Recommend the involvement of resident volunteers for implementation of eco-club activities that nurture and protect the local ecosystem. 5

OR

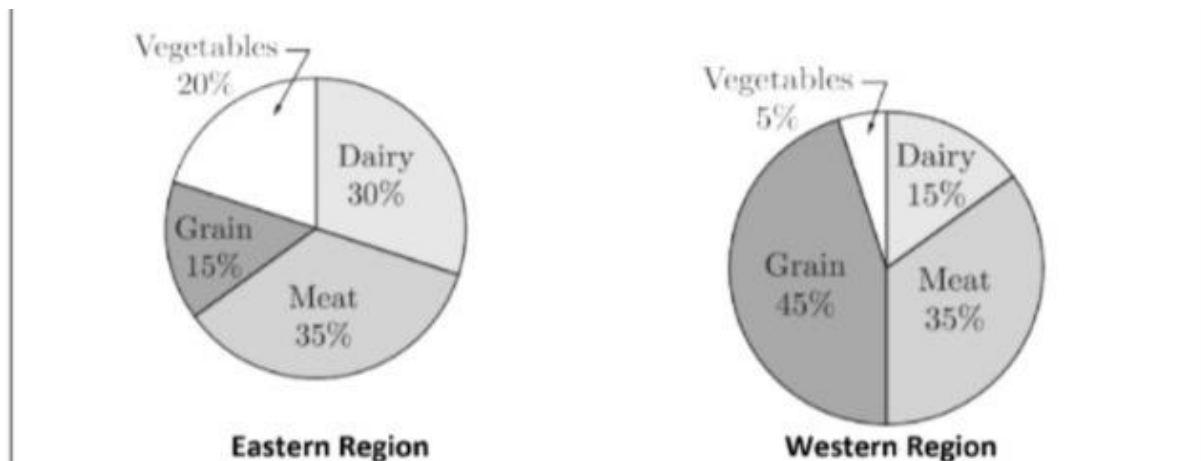
4.B. As Armaan Khan, the School Literary Captain of Ujjwal Academy, Old City, Kiladerabad, you believe that languages can help bridge regional divides and promote unity.

Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily, in about 120 words suggesting the introduction of an online regional language learning programme managed and run by student councils and language clubs in the city. The programme aims to help residents who have recently relocated to a new region in picking up the local language organically. Share the importance and credibility of such a programme and suggest a feasible way to execute it along with possible activities.

5. Attempt ANY ONE from (a) and (b) given below. 5

(a) The charts below show agricultural production in two different regions (eastern and western) of the country. Write an analytical paragraph in 100-120 words by selecting and

reporting the main features, and making comparisons where relevant.



OR

(b) Read the following excerpt from a speech by Malala Yousafzai in her address to the United Nations, July 2013.

The wise saying, “A pen is mightier than a sword” was true. The extremists are afraid of books and pens. The power of education frightens them. They are afraid of women. The power of the voice of women.

Write a paragraph to analyse the given argument. You could think about what alternative explanations might weaken the given conclusion and include rationale/evidence that would strengthen/counter the given argument.

5

SECTION C –LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

6. Read the following extracts and answer **any one** of the following two -

(a) or (b):

5

(a) The jingling thud of his bamboo woke us up from sleep and we ran to meet and greet him. Why was it so? Was it for the love of the loaf? Not at all. The loaves were bought by some Paskine or Bastine, the maid-servant of the house! What we longed for were those bread-bangles which we chose carefully. Sometimes it was sweet bread of special make.

i. What was special about those bread bangles sometimes?

(a) The sweet bread of special make

(b) The fresh morning breads

(c) The maid servant of the house bought the loaves of bread

(d) Both (a) and (b)

1

ii. Whose bamboo is being discussed here?

(a) The baker

(b) Paskine

(c) Bastine

- (d) The watchman 1
- iii. What made the narrator and his friends wake up in the morning? 2
- iv. State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE:
- In the olden days, baker in Goa was known as pader. 1

OR

(b) I think he knew I made a little money this way but he did not seem to mind. Anil made money by fits and starts. He would borrow one week, lend the next. He kept worrying about his next cheque, but as soon as it arrived, he would go out and celebrate. It seems he wrote for magazines - a queer way to make a living!

i. Complete the following with a phrase from extract:

OPINION

REASON

_____ Anil received Money intermittently.

1

ii. The information in the extract suggests that Anil could be a

- (a) salaried professional
- (b) freelancer
- (c) business man
- (d) volunteer

1

iii. Why did Hari Singh think that writing for magazines was - a queer way to make a living?

2

iv. "I think he knew I made a little money this way"- Making money 'this way' is

1

- (a) sensible
- (b) chivalrous
- (c) unethical
- (d) Aggressive

7. Read the following extracts and answer **any one** of the following two,

(a) or (b):

5

(a) Some say the world will end in fire

Some say in ice.

From what I've tasted of desire

I hold with those who favour fire.

- i. Which literary device has been used in 'I hold with those who favour fire'?
- (a) Simile
 - (b) Anaphora
 - (c) Alliteration
 - (d) Enjambment 1
- ii. What predictions do the people make for the ending of the world? 2
- iii. What does 'Fire' symbolise according to the poet? 1
- (a) Desire
 - (b) Avarice
 - (c) Greed
 - (d) All of these
- iv. State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE:
- People think that the world is a beautiful place to live in. 1

OR

- (b) No use to say 'O there are other balls' :

An ultimate shaking grief fixes the boy
 As he stands rigid, trembling, staring down
 All his young days into the harbour where
 His ball went. I would not intrude on him;
 A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now
 He senses first responsibility
 In a world of possessions. People will take
 Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy.

- i. What does the poet mean by 'first responsibility'? 2
- ii. Complete the analogy by selecting the suitable word from the extract:
- privy: secret :: sympathetic : _____
- (Clue: Just like privy is sharing in a secret, similarly sympathetic is sharing in...) 1
- iii. Which figure of speech is used in the above lines?
- (a) metaphor
 - (b) personification

(c)anaphora

(d)simile

1

iv. Which of the following emotions does the boy feel when the ball goes into the dark water of the harbour?

1. Grief

2. Disbelief

3. Hope

4. Desperation

5. Excitement

(a)Only 1 and 2

(b)Only 2 and 4

(c)Only 2, 3 and 5

(d)Only 1, 2 and 4

1

8. Answer **ANY FOUR** of the following in about 40-50 words each:

4x3=12

i How would a life on a tower be different from a life anywhere else for Amanda?

ii. Do you think the trees are justified in the revolt? State the values that man should possess to stop the revolt.

iii. After achieving political emancipation what does Mandela want to do in South Africa?

iv. "He disappeared at high speed down the aircraft." What did Mij do when he came back to Maxwell's seat?

v. What makes Chubukov misunderstand the purpose of Lomov's visit ?

9. Answer **ANY TWO** of the following in about 40-50 words each.

2X3=6

i. How did Ausable befool Max about the balcony?

ii. How does Think-Tank interpret the library found by his crew on earth? Why does he ask Omega to eat a book?

iii. Why did the police arrest Horace Danby when he had not kept the jewels stolen from Grange safe?

10. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following in about 100-120 words.

1x6=6

i. "Difficulties do come in our lives, but they are not there to stay forever." Comment on this statement with reference to the poem 'Fog' by Carl Sandburg.

OR

.ii. Imagine Anne Gregory grows up to be a motivational speaker. As Anne Gregory, write a speech she delivers to a group of teenagers in which she talks about the true nature of humans as they are always carried away by the outer beauty which is insignificant, and never pay attention to the true nature of the person.

11. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following in about 100-120 words. 1x6=6

i. “We are too involved in materialistic things, and they don’t satisfy us. The loving relationships we have, the universe around us, we take these things for granted.”– Matilda was never satisfied with her life and desired more. The given quote reflects her character. Justify.

OR

ii. “A good education can change anyone. A good teacher can change everything.” Discuss this with reference to Bholi.

